

The Claremont City Council held a meeting on Tuesday, December 21, 2021, in the Council Chambers of City Hall.

The meeting was called to order by Mayor Lovett at 6:30 p.m.

Members of the Council present:

Ward I Councilor Andrew O’Hearne
At-Large Councilor Dale Girard
Assistant Mayor Allen Damren
Mayor Charlene Lovett
At-Large Councilor Debora Matteau
At-Large Councilor Nicholas Koloski
Ward II Councilor James Contois (home, alone)

Absent:

At-Large Councilor Michael Demars
Ward III Councilor Jonathan Stone

Also present:

Edward Morris, City Manager

CITIZEN’S FORUM

No one spoke.

OLD BUSINESS

Transition Planning Follow-Up

Councilor Girard (Mayor-Elect) said he made contact with Alan Gould, Municipal Resources Inc. (MRI), and he was sent an agreement, which was sent out to the Council. The cost for the recruitment package will be \$15,500, to take the process from start to finish and to bring 3-5 candidates back to the Council. Part of process will require Mr. Gould to interview Councilors; he wants the Council to work on the ideal candidate profile statement. There is no additional charge for the asset packet. There will be additional charges for advertising, which the City will pay directly. It will take about 30 days to receive resumes. MRI will screen those resumes down to 12-15 candidates, and those candidates will be sent essays, which they will have 10 days to return. Once the essays are returned, MRI will interview semi-finalists and then they will narrow down the list to 3-5 candidates, and those will be presented to the Council. Because John

MacLean will be in Claremont, Mr. Gould will get information (budget, staffing, etc.) directly from Mr. MacLean, instead of through the Council.

Councilor O'Hearne said he would rather wait until the three new Councilors come on board next month before going forward with this. Mayor Lovett said this contract is pretty much the same as the 2016 contract with MRI. She said that if the incoming Councilors have concerns, they can be addressed with MRI, also, the majority of the Council is not changing. Councilor O'Hearne doesn't want to tie the next Council to something that can't be changed. Councilor Matteau said the new Council will be sworn in on January 5th. She doesn't believe any of the incoming Councilors would want anything drastically different. She's concerned with the timeline. Councilor Girard said that information will have to come back to the Council to be approved and the incoming Councilors will be involved.

Mayor Lovett verified that once this is signed by her, the process begins. She would ask Mr. Gould to be very clear about the pay range, as there was an issue with that during the previous search.

Mayor Lovett asked about the 4-6 candidates discussed in the 2016 agreement and only 3-5 candidates in this agreement, and Councilor Girard said that is what the current market is typically offering.

Mayor Lovett said this draft does not include a Council point-of-contact; it was in the old one.

A motion was made by Councilor Matteau and seconded by Assistant Mayor Damren to approve the Professional Services Agreement with MRI for the recruitment of a City Manager with the clarifications that the Mayor had brought up (point-of-contact).

Councilor O'Hearne said he was not comfortable voting on a contract he hasn't seen. Unless a call can be made to Mr. Gould and get him on record agreeing to those changes.

Councilor Girard tried calling Mr. Gould, but the call was not answered.

There was a discussion about the changes and the majority of the Council was in agreement to move forward with the motion as stated.

Roll call vote:

O'Hearne – abstain

Girard - yes

Damren - yes

Matteau - yes

Koloski - yes

Contois - yes

Lovett - yes

Motion carried 6-0, with 1 abstain.

Councilor Girard said Mr. Gould said that a specific email address will be made available for anyone to use during this process.

CONSULTATION WITH LEGAL COUNSEL

None.

ADJOURNMENT

At 7:05 p.m., a motion was made by Councilor Matteau and seconded by Assistant Mayor Damren to adjourn.

Roll call vote:

O’Hearne – stated to “move on” without voicing a vote

Girard - yes

Damren - yes

Matteau - yes

Koloski - yes

Contois - yes

Lovett - yes

Motion carried 6-0.

Respectfully Submitted,

Dorée M. Russell
Clerk to the Council